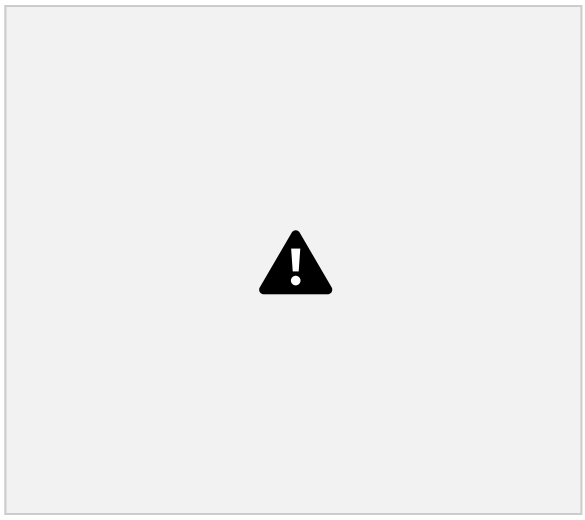


Clemens Mill School Council
Meeting Minutes
Oct 14, 2026

ATTENDEES

(V = 2026/2027 voting member)

Robert Wilson - Principal Sandra Jovanovic - Vice-Principal Bibi Corbeil - Teacher Rep Kim Fowler - Community Rep Carrie-Ann Delane - YMCA Rep
Chantelle Tinnes - Co-Chair Ashley Church - Co-Chair
Cheraine Serrador (V) Shannon Wall (V)
Rhonda Chamberlain (V) John MacLachlan (V)
Salena Mather (V) Gulwinder Singh Sidhu (V)
Andrew Church (V) Chantel Tirbeni (V)
Dipesh Patel (V) Rebecca Goodard (V)
Christine Dalsto (V) Vina Danger (V)
Nicole Brooks (V) Vasco Serrador
Zac Jones Shana Jabeen
Asfia Akbar

Regrets

Izaz Shah (V) Rene Corbeil (V)
Maham Asrar (V) Gaganpreet Sawhney (V)
Amanda Lee

Meeting Minutes

1. **Welcome**
   - Territorial Acknowledgment.
   - Gr 7/8 created individual territorial acknowledgements that they turned into a video for staff meeting.
   - K1 has a poster that they discuss every morning at an age appropriate level.

2. **Budget Summary 2026/2027**

- 2026/2027 Starting funds of $46k, which is earmarked for playground upgrades.

3. Fiddlesticks Update

- Kim Fowler is the Executive Director of Fiddlesticks Community Centre. ● This year Fiddlesticks has been selected by TW Properties for a food donation partnership. For every 1LB of donated food that Fiddlesticks receives, TW Properties will provide Fiddlesticks with $1.
- Fiddlesticks requests that any food donations raised by Clemens Mill be sent to Fiddlesticks to be part of this initiative. Fiddlesticks will take all donated food to TW Properties for weighing and processing.
- At the end of the initiative Fiddlesticks will donate some equipment to the school using the funds it receives from TW Properties. They will also provide a pizza lunch to the school that donates the most food (by weight).
- Clemens Mill Social Justice Committee to determine if they would like to partner with Fiddlesticks on this.

4. Principal's Update

- Terry Fox run and Orange Shirt Day were successful.
- Trailblazers - Gr 5/6 have been walking safe routes to and from school. They are not supervisors, but have received training and wear fluro vests to provide safe routes. ● EQAO results from last year have been released. In-depth discussion on the results will happen in the November meeting and personal results should be sent to families next week.
- Food Drive next week.
- Take Me Outside (spirit day) next week.
- PD Day Monday 26 October.
- Progress reports will be released 16 November.
- School picture day scheduled for 02 November.

5. 2026/2027 Initiatives and Budget

Scientist in Schools	$2.5k
Book Workshops	$2.5k
Carnavale	$1k
Read-A-Thon	$1.5k
Musical	$2k
End of Year Trip	$5k
Other (community garden, WinterFest, End of Year celebration)	$3k
Total	**$17.5k**

- Expected income will be more than $17.5k and also expect that some items will fund

themselves e.g. Read-A-Thon.

- Book Writing Workshop - Local author will have workshops with Gr 4-6 (6 classes) to create books and illustrations. The school will then receive 1 book per class or can purchase a book for each student.
- Read-A-Thon - Same budget as last year. Looking at a $2 minimum sponsorship in order to confirm commitment. Author readings will happen as per last year. Book Fair would be held during or following the Read-A-Thon.
- Scientists in Schools - Gr 1-6 (13 classes) would all have an opportunity to book a workshop. Each workshop is tied to the curriculum and we would receive a discount by booking early. Received positive feedback last year. If Gr 7/8 teachers show interest more money can be requested from School Council.
- End of Year Trip - Gr 8. Open to ideas.
- Musical - Not sure yet what the plan will be.
- WinterFest - Inclusive family event in Feb focusing on crafts. Event should fund itself through sale of hot chocolate/popcorn and can also use PRO grant for additional funding. Advertise for vendors who will purchase tables, may need budget to advertise. ● **MOTION** to approve draft budget of $17.5k:
    - **12 YES, Motion PASSED.**

6. Strawberry Sunshine Fundraiser

- Handmade soy candles from a Guelph artisan.
- $17 per candle, $5 goes to the school. Minimum order of 30 candles, suggested run time of 2 weeks. Free delivery.
- Q about why we need to fundraise if approved budget is already covered by projected income. Forecasted income is $25k which exceeds approved budget.
- Suggestion that we hold off on fundraising until we know we need more money. Also that food items are very successful fundraisers.
- Idea SHELVED until a later date.

7. Book Writing Workshop

- Budget of $2.5k.
- Discussion of kindies creating their own books through class. Usually parents have to pay for this, possible that the School Council could fund this also.
- **MOTION** to approve the Book Writing Workshop for Gr 4-6:
    - **11 YES, Motion PASSED**

8. Playground Upgrade

- Budget of $46k, suggested breakdown:
    - Accessible roller slide approx $26k
    - Monkey bars replacement approx $20k
- Go to the WRDSB with our wishlist to see what we can get to maximise the budget. We do not have an overview of prices until the board advises, so we need to make sure the wish list captures everything we could want.

- School council will set priorities. Prioritising needs and inclusivity.
- Q re possibility of adding structures for Gr 7/8? Could cause issue with size difference

between Gr 7/8 and Gr 4-6.

- Original plan from last playground upgrade (Gr 1-3) was for the next upgrade to focus on older grades. Last year the school council bought new basketball rings and volleyball posts/nets for older grades.
- **MOTION** to prioritise replacing the Gr 4-6 monkey bars. Accessible slide as secondary focus:
    - **11 YES, Motion PASSED**

9. Subcommittee Volunteers

- Pizza - currently have enough volunteers but can always use more. Shannon Wall looking to teach the Excel portion of pizza ordering to anyone if interested. ● Bingo - Co-Chairs are taking over coordinator position. New volunteers to be added to mailing list are John MacLachlan and Rebecca Goddard.
- Grants - PRO Grant will be finalised by Mr. Wilson and Co-Chairs. Cheraine Serrador will share list of potential grants with Co-Chairs.
- Speaker Series - Scientist in Schools. Budget already approved by School Council.
- WRAPSC - Christine Dalsto.
- WinterFest - Shannon Wall, Rhonda Chamberlain and Christine Dalsto. ● Fundraising - Currently not a focus as we already have enough income to support the approved budget. No volunteers.
- Read-A-Thon / Book Fair - Co-Chairs and Chantel Tirbeni.
- End of Year Event - Rhonda Chamberlain, Nicole Brooks, Chantel Tirbeni and Salena Mather.
- Playground Upgrade - Christine Dalsto, Shannon Wall, Cheraine Serrador, John MacLachlan, Salena Mather and Dipesh Patel.

10. WRAPSC Update

- Municipal Elections 26 October 2026. Read up on the Trustee candidates and vote.
- No policy update regarding allergies in WRDSB.
- Student and Family Support Office is now up and running. Provide similar support to the Trustees. Start with your teacher and principal before requesting help.
- School Council bylaws are available on Clemens Mill website.

11. Meeting close

- Next meeting 11 November 2026.